

The Crucible – Act One

Arthur Miller

Choose Your Own Path

Select four of the following items to answer completely.

1. What is wrong with Betty? Why does Parris call for Hale? Is Parris simply a worried parent, or does he have other concerns? Support your answer with examples.
2. What clues suggest that Abigail's reputation has become questionable?
3. Thomas and Ann Putnam seem to have reasons to be bitter about the course their lives have taken in Salem. Discuss.
4. Frequently in serious literature one character assumes the role of the voice of reason. In Act One, the voice of reason is Rebecca Nurse. Examine the first Act for ways in which Rebecca attempts to apply reason to the situation.
5. Describe the character of John Proctor. Is he independent or a follower? Honest or hypocritical? How does he feel about himself, and why might he feel that way? Explain with examples.
6. Who is Elizabeth Proctor? What does Abigail think of her? How might this affect the outcome of the play?
7. What connotations might there be in Giles' questions to Reverend Hale about the meaning of his wife's reading habits? Are these intentional, or are Giles' questions innocent? Use quotes from the text to support your answers.

The End of the Road

Complete each of the following activities.

8. Craft a labeled web of the relationships introduced in Act One. Include the following:
 - Ruth
 - Mary
 - Betty
 - Mercy
 - Tituba
 - Abigail
 - Giles Corey
 - Ann Putnam
 - John Proctor
 - Reverend Hale
 - Rebecca Nurse
 - Reverend Parris
 - Thomas Putnam
 - Elizabeth Proctor
9. The principle accusers in *The Crucible* are young, unmarried women. From what you have read, what can be deduced about the status of single women in Puritan society? Could the celebrity effect of allegedly being able to identify witches change their status? In what way? Use the reading and personal experience to support your answer.